

Table 1 Base case input per year

Parameters	Mean	SE	Units	Distribution	Source	
Survival probabilities						
DFS to DFS	0.763	0.030		Beta	[18]	
DFS to DM	0.196	0.030	13/73	Beta	[18]	
DFS to Death	0.041	0.030	3/73	Beta	[18]	
DM to DM	0.804	0.030		Beta	[18]	
DM to Death	0.196	0.030	13/73	Beta	[18]	
Death	1.000					
Mort. related pulmonary infection UC	0.015	0.001	4.1/24.47/11	Beta	[21]	
Mort. related pulmonary infection HME	0.005	0.001	3.7/74.48/11	Beta	[21]	
Probabilities						
Pulmonary infection UC	0.285	0.120	6.79/24.47	Beta	[21]	
Pulmonary infection HME	0.066	0.105	4.92/74.48	Beta	[21]	
Use of benzodiazepines UC	0.275	0.030	11/40	Beta	[17]	
Use of benzodiazepines HME	0.110	0.030	2/18	Beta	[17]	
Utilities						
HME use	0.952	0.015		Beta	[25]	
Usual care (UC)	0.830	0.015		Beta	[25]	
Palliative period	0.500	0.015		Beta	Assumption	
	Mean (Zloty)	(Euros)	SE	Lower/upper (%)	Distribution	Source
Costs in PLN						
Pulmonary infection ^a	1,627	(2564)	207.55	±25	Gamma	Hosp
Including: 4 days admission	4 × 325	(4 × 575)	41.45	±25	Gamma	Hosp
Antibiotics ^b	49	(85)	6.21	±25	Gamma	Hosp
Outpatient clinic	229	(129)	29.15	±25	Gamma	Hosp
Plain X-ray	50	(50)	6.38	±25	Gamma	Hosp
Sleep medication ^c	128	(672)	16.29	±25	Gamma	Hosp
HME package ^d	13,966	(5,575)	1,781	±25	Gamma	Atos Med.
Stoma cover ^e	228	(365)	29.10	±25	Gamma	Hosp
Suction system ^f	42	(50)	5.34	±25	Gamma	Hosp
Ultrasonic nebulizer-hospital	832	(2915)	106.14	±25	Gamma	Hosp
Saline use at home ^g	785	(2,035)	100.13	±25	Gamma	Hosp

Hosp: personal communication; data from several hospitals in different regions in Poland (see Supplementary Appendix), using questionnaires; Atos Medical: available at: <http://www.atosmedical.com>

SE standard error, HME heat and moisture exchanger, UC usual care, Mort. mortality, DFS disease-free survival, DM distant metastasis

^a Including: 4 days of hospital admission, antibiotics, plain X-ray, outpatient clinic

^b Antibiotics: Metromidazol; Cefalospomyn; Amoxiclavicaan; Zinnat 5–14 days

^c Estazolam (nocturnal), estimation for daily consumption 0.20–0.50 PLN

^d Including one HME cassette per day, one adhesive per 1–1.5 day, and 1 laryngectomy tube or stoma buttons per year

^e Estimation 0.25–1 PLN/day;

^f Container 7 PLN; Tubing 2,50 PLN/2 days; Suction tip 0,32 PLN approx. 6/day

^g Sodium chloride ampules 9 mg/ml per 15 pieces (assumption 5 pieces per day)